The agreement could have been derailed just hours after the two leaders talked, when the USS *Illinois* (SSN-786), a *Virginia*-class nuclear attack submarine, encountered a PLAN South Sea Fleet *Yuan*-class diesel-electric attack submarine off the Riau Archipelago northeast of Singapore. The *Illinois* had picked up the Chinese sub on September 22 and quietly shadowed it for two days before being discovered in turn by its Chinese quarry. Having received information of the submarine attack on the *Liaoning*, the Chinese assumed they were an active target and flooded and opened their torpedo tubes. At that point, the *Illinois* launched a single Mk-48 torpedo that destroyed the Chinese sub. By the time the South Sea Fleet realized their sub was missing on September 29, the inertia of the political agreement between Washington and Beijing was too strong to overcome, and Chinese authorities ordered all forces to adhere to the cease-fire, which had been in effect for four full days.

VI. The Aftermath

The Negotiations and Agreement

Since Congress had not declared war, President Newsom could negotiate and make a settlement directly with Xi Jinping, without having to seek congressional approval. Further, since no territory had been taken by either side, the two leaders agreed to ratify the military status quo at the time of the cease-fire and avoid bringing in diplomats. The commander of US Indo-Pacific Command met the chief of the Joint Staff Department of the PLA's Central Military Commission in Singapore on September 26 and reached an agreement on a permanent cease-fire on September 28.

By the terms of the agreement, each side agreed to inform the other of naval and air activities taking place in the Yellow, East, and South China Seas; the US would notify Beijing of any passage of US naval ships through the South China Sea, while China would undertake to